

Agile, Scrum and Delivery Methods

Waterfall, Agile, Scrum, Kanban, XP, Lean and hybrid ways to organize development and delivery.

Agile is not the same as Scrum

Agile is a set of values and principles for adaptive value delivery. Scrum is a specific framework. Kanban, XP, Lean and hybrid approaches are also used.

Scrum in simple terms

Work starts from a Product Backlog. In each Sprint, the team selects work into a Sprint Backlog and aims to produce an Increment that meets the Definition of Done.

Accountabilities and stakeholders

Current Scrum defines Product Owner, Scrum Master and Developers. Stakeholders are people interested in the product. QA specialists can be part of Developers and collaborate on quality throughout the Sprint.

Scrum events

Sprint Planning establishes a goal and plan; Daily Scrum inspects progress; Sprint Review evaluates the Increment with stakeholders; Retrospective improves how the team works.

Backlog, User Story and Acceptance Criteria

A backlog organizes needs. A User Story is a common way to express user value. Acceptance Criteria make acceptance conditions explicit and help QA identify examples, risks and gaps.

Kanban

Kanban emphasizes workflow visualization, work-in-progress limits and continuous improvement. Lead time and cycle time help teams understand flow.

Waterfall and V-Model

Waterfall organizes work in more sequential phases. The V-Model relates specification/development activities to corresponding test levels. Real projects may combine practices from multiple models.

QA in agile teams

QA participates in refinement, discusses testability, prepares data and environments, tests during development, automates appropriate checks and communicates risk before delivery.

Agile in practice



Agility does not mean no process or documentation. It means learning and adapting through feedback, prioritizing value and making work visible. QA contributes by surfacing risk, testability and technical feedback early.

Choosing an approach

Scrum helps when Sprint cadence and goals fit; Kanban emphasizes continuous flow; XP deepens engineering practices; Lean targets waste. Teams may combine practices when they understand why they use them.